WTR 8 (#270268)

Author(s)
This pre-registration is currently anonymous to enable blind peer-review.
It has one author.

Pre-registered on:
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1) Have any data been collected for this study already?
No, no data have been collected for this study yet.

2) What's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?
The main purpose of this study is to replicate the effect that victims' post-transgression responses (PTRs) to seek revenge or forgive by ability for future actions to be monitored (yes, no) by relationship value (low, high) affect transgressors' welfare trade-offs (e.g., vigilance to not transgress again, worry, rumination, self-control, non-apology, apology) by using a fully experimental design. It will also test the moderating role of relationship value on previously established PTR by Monitoring interactions. Finally, this study will test the mediating role of cost-benefit analysis. Overall, we predict that the effect of victims' PTRs on transgressors' welfare trade-offs will be differentially affected by the victims' ability to monitor the future actions of the transgressor (or not), and that relationship value will moderate, and cost-benefits will mediate, the relation. Based on Tooby et al.'s (2008) theorizing about welfare trade-offs, McCullough et al.'s (2013) theorizing about revenge and forgiveness systems, and Struthers et al. (2025) theorizing about posttransgression responses, monitoring, and welfare trade-off ratios, we predict mediated moderations among our key variables. More specifically, we predict that transgressors will be more vigilant about not committing future transgressions (i.e., higher WTR) when victims seek revenge and can monitor transgressors' future actions. In comparison, we predict that transgressors will be more vigilant about not committing future transgressions when victims forgive and cannot monitor transgressors' future actions. These effects are hypothesized to enhance based on the value individuals hold for the relationship. Based on our design, we predict a PTR (revenge, forgiveness) by monitor (yes, no) by relationship value (low, high), 2 x 2 x 2, between-groups interaction on transgressors' welfare trade-off ratios (WTRs) toward the victim.

3) Describe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.
Transgressors' WTRs toward victims are operationalized as transgressors' cognitive, affective, and behavioral vigilance reflected in transgressors' worry, rumination, self-control over not committing future transgressions, non-apology, apology, and assignment of ballots. We use the multi-item Worry Domains Questionnaire-Short Form (Stober & Joorman, 2001) (e.g., I would worry that I would lose the other person's respect), Rumination about an Interpersonal Offence Scale (Wade, et al., 2008) (e.g., I wouldn't be able to stop thinking about how I affected the person I hurt), Brief Self-Control Scale (Tangney et al., 2004 (e.g., I would say inappropriate things to the other person), Guilfoyle's (2019) non-apology/apology scale (e.g., I want to assure the person that I hurt that I won't do this again), assignment of ballots, and written response to the victim.
The Cost and Benefits of Relationships Survey (Dardis et al., 2013 (e.g., How committed would the person who you hurt be to their relationship with you in the future).

4) How many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?
This study uses a 2x2x2 experimental between groups design. The key independent variables are victims' PTRs (revenge, forgiveness), ability to monitor transgressors' future actions (no, yes), and relationship value (low, high). Participants will be randomly assigned to one of the 8 conditions that emerge from the 2x2x2 design.

5) Specify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.
To test our primary prediction of a 3-way interaction, we will conduct 2x2x2 between-group ANOVAs on our dependent variables as well as Hayes' (2012) PROCESS analysis (models 1, 3, and 8) to test for mediated moderation. Simple effects will be tested to probe significant interaction effects. In addition, simple slopes will be used to probe three-way interactions.

6) Describe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for excluding observations.
The exclusion criteria for the sample will be: (1) incomplete responding, (2) random responders as determined by the Conscientious Responders Scale (Marjanovic et al., 2012), and (3) potential outliers.

7) How many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size? No need to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.
Participants will be recruited using our psychology department's undergraduate research participant pool. Based on a priori power analyses to detect a small to moderate interaction effect size, f = .15 (based on typical effect sizes found in our previous research), to determine 90% power, $\alpha = .05$, N = 469. Given potential participant exclusions, we hope to recruit approximately 600 participants.

8) Anything else you would like to pre-register? (e.g., secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)
We will include measures of other potential and exploratory moderators and mediators, e.g., power, mindfulness.